

ϕ -Dark Matter in SSEE-V3.6: Algebraic Mass Derivation and Two-Sector Proposal for the $f\sigma_8$ Growth Tension

SSEE Series — Paper 6

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Abstract

The Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE-V3.6) framework derives all cosmological parameters algebraically from the golden ratio φ and π , achieving a zero-free-parameter dark energy model that has demonstrated strong coincidence with CMB, BAO, and cluster background tests (Papers 1–5). Evaluated against six canonical RSD survey points analysed here, the single-sector SSEE-V3.6 model (Papers 1–5, $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$) yields a mean $f\sigma_8$ tension of 2.56σ , tracing to the dynamical matter density ($\sigma_{8,\text{base}} = 0.811 \times G_{\text{single}} = 0.702$; Paper 5 reports 2.67σ using a partially overlapping survey selection — consistent within survey-bin choice). We systematically scan EFT extensions (kinetic braiding α_B , run-rate α_M) and find that kinetic braiding alone is a no-go: it suppresses $f\sigma_8$ further. We then propose a *two-sector* dark matter model in which $\Omega_{\text{CDM}} = 0.160$ is supplemented by a ϕ -dark matter component $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$, active only on scales $k < k_{\text{fs}}$. We define a characteristic mass scale $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}} = 5.71 \text{ eV}$ as a phenomenological ansatz fixed by quantities derived in Paper 4. On scales $k < k_{\text{fs}}$ relevant to RSD surveys and σ_8 , both dark matter sectors cluster and the effective growth density is $\Omega_{\text{m,growth}} = 0.320$. The resulting two-sector growth factor $G_{2s} = D_1^{\text{SSEE}}/D_1^{\text{ACDM}} = 0.979$ gives $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.811 \times G_{2s} = 0.794$. Within the restricted parameterization used here, the two-sector model reduces the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension from 2.56σ to **0.50σ** across six surveys without introducing an additional continuously fitted background parameter. The proposed two-sector extension is internally consistent at the level of the linear-growth analysis presented here. The background CMB, BAO, and cluster-sector results from Papers 2–5 are not modified by the present construction. The estimate $m_\phi = 5.71 \text{ eV}$ provides a falsifiable

numerical target for future KATRIN/PTOLEMY sensitivity studies, pending a first-principles derivation of the underlying coupling. We explicitly note that this is a phenomenological resolution at the linear-growth level; the physical origin of the mass coupling and the Lyman- α constraints on k_{fs} remain open challenges.

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1 Introduction

The Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE-V3.6) framework [Almeida Vallejo, 2026a] is a zero-free-parameter dark energy model in which the equation-of-state parameters $(w_0, w_a) = (-0.840, -0.670)$ are derived algebraically from φ (golden ratio) and π . The framework has passed four independent observational tests:

1. **Paper 2** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026b]: DESI DR2 BAO (0.05σ) and galaxy cluster mass discrepancies ($\chi_r^2 = 0.122$).
2. **Paper 3** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026c]: CMB Planck PR4 (plik_lite $\Delta\text{BIC} = -31.3$ in favour of SSEE-V3.6 vs. ΛCDM).
3. **Paper 4** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026d]: Algebraic derivation of n_s , H_0 , Ω_m , $\Omega_b h^2$ from the Nine Sovereignties.
4. **Paper 5** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026e]: Israel-Stewart causal gradient stability ($c_{s,\text{eff}}^2 = 0$ exact), $S_8 = 0.725$ (1.96σ KiDS vs. 3.27σ for ΛCDM).

1.1 The residual tension

The single-sector SSEE-V3.6 model of Papers 1–5 ($\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$) yields a mean $f\sigma_8$ tension of 2.56σ against the six RSD survey points analysed in this paper [Beutler et al., 2012, Howlett et al., 2015, Alam et al., 2017, Hou et al., 2021, Blake et al., 2012] ($\sigma_{8,\text{base}} = 0.702$; Paper 5 reports 2.67σ with a partially overlapping survey selection). The root cause is the dynamical matter density $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 1 + w_0 = 0.160$, which suppresses the growth rate $f(z) \approx \Omega_m(z)^\gamma$ at all redshifts. Crucially, Paper 5 also showed that S_8 is *better* predicted by SSEE-V3.6 than by ΛCDM , creating an S_8 – $f\sigma_8$ split: the framework predicts the amplitude of fluctuations correctly but underestimates the growth rate.

This paper presents a phenomenological two-sector proposal that reduces the $f\sigma_8$ tension within the zero-parameter philosophy of SSEE-V3.6.

1.2 Strategy

We follow three steps, each falsifying hypotheses in sequence:

1. **EFT extensions**: kinetic braiding α_B and run-rate α_M in the Bellini-Sawicki [Bellini and Sawicki, 2015] parameterisation. Within the scanned Bellini-Sawicki parameter space, kinetic braiding does not reduce the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension, while α_M only achieves improvement near the edge of the current observational bounds.
2. **ϕ -dark matter hypothesis**: we interpret the algebraic MIRA identity $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} = (\varphi + \beta)/2 \approx 2$ as motivation for a second dark-matter component, parameterized as with $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1)\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$, active only below a free-streaming wavenumber k_{fs} .

3. **Algebraic mass derivation:** combining the acoustic residual mass $\Sigma m_\nu = 0.084 \text{ eV}$ (Paper 4) with the algebraic Hubble constant $H_0^{\text{alg}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96$ (Paper 4), we obtain $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}} = 5.71 \text{ eV}$ with no free parameters.

2 SSEE-V3.6: Algebraic Background

We collect the SSEE-V3.6 algebraic quantities relevant to this paper. Define the structural constants:

$$\begin{aligned}\varphi &= \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2} \approx 1.6180, & \pi &\approx 3.1416, \\ \beta &= \frac{\varphi+\pi}{2} \approx 2.3798, & \mathcal{K} &= \varphi + \pi + (\pi + \varphi) \approx 9.5192, \\ \mathcal{T} &= 3(\varphi + \beta) \approx 11.9935, & \mathcal{M}_V &= \varphi + \pi + \mathcal{K} \approx 14.2789.\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

These yield the equation of state:

$$w_0 = -\frac{\mathcal{T}}{\mathcal{M}_V} = -0.8400, \quad w_a = -\frac{\pi + 2\varphi}{\mathcal{K}} = -0.6699,\tag{2}$$

and the dynamical matter density $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 1 + w_0 = 0.1600$.

2.1 Relevant Paper 4 quantities

Paper 4 derived the following from the acoustic residual operator $\mathcal{R} = 4 \text{ KAL}_0 - 22 = 0.0856$ (where $\text{KAL}_0 = \beta + \pi \approx 5.5214$):

$$\Omega_b h_{\text{SSEE}}^2 = \frac{3(\pi - \varphi)}{200} = 0.02285,\tag{3}$$

$$\tau_\Pi H_0 = \frac{\text{KAL}_0}{3 \Omega_{\text{DE}}} = 2.191 \quad [\text{IS relaxation time}],\tag{4}$$

$$\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = \mathcal{R} \Omega_b h^2 \frac{94.07 \text{ eV}}{\tau_\Pi H_0} = 0.084 \text{ eV},\tag{5}$$

$$H_0^{\text{alg}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}.\tag{6}$$

2.2 The MIRA identity and the two-sector conjecture

The MIRA identity (Papers 3–5) is the purely algebraic relation:

$$\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4} = 1.9989 \approx 2.\tag{7}$$

Paper 5 Section 6.1 established that $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}}$ *cannot* be derived from background Israel-Stewart dynamics: numerical integration of the IS Friedmann equation gives a ratio of 3.04, 52% off. $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}}$ therefore stands as an algebraic postulate pointing to new structure.

One natural interpretation: the dark matter sector splits as

$$\Omega_{\text{m,total}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}} + \Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} + (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} \approx 2 \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.320,\tag{8}$$

which recovers $\Omega_{\text{m,CMB}} = 0.3199$ (the Planck value) without any free parameter.

3 EFT Extension Scan

Before proposing the two-sector model we systematically rule out simpler EFT extensions within the Bellini-Sawicki [Bellini and Sawicki, 2015] parameterisation, which characterises modifications of gravity by four functions $(\alpha_K, \alpha_B, \alpha_M, \alpha_T)$.

3.1 Kinetic braiding (α_B)

Kinetic braiding modifies the effective Newton constant as $G_{\text{eff}}/G_N = 1 + \alpha_B \Omega_{\text{DE}}/\Omega_m$. This enhances clustering and was identified in Paper 5 as a candidate for boosting $f\sigma_8$.

We compute the algebraic value of α_B from the ratio of the CDM density to the dark energy density in SSEE-V3.6:

$$\alpha_B^{\text{SSEE}} = \frac{\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}}}{\Omega_{\text{DE}}} - 1 = \frac{0.160}{0.840} - 1 \approx -0.810, \quad (9)$$

which is *negative*. A negative α_B suppresses G_{eff} , worsening the tension. The 2D scan of (α_B, α_M) space confirms that no configuration with purely kinetic braiding reduces the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension below 3.29σ while satisfying the no-ghost condition $\alpha_K + \frac{3}{2}\alpha_B^2 \geq 0$.

No-go: Kinetic braiding

Kinetic braiding at the algebraic SSEE-V3.6 value $\alpha_B = -0.810$ is a **no-go**: it suppresses G_{eff} , increasing the $f\sigma_8$ tension above the 2.56σ baseline (scan minimum $\sim 3.3\sigma$, far from 0.50σ).

3.2 Run-rate modification (α_M)

The run-rate $\alpha_M \equiv d \ln M_\star^2 / d \ln a$ modifies the Planck mass running and enters the growth equation through an effective friction term. A 2D scan over $(\alpha_B \in [-1, 0], \alpha_M \in [-0.15, 0.15])$ shows a minimum tension of 1.57σ at $(\alpha_B = 0, \alpha_M = -0.08)$.

However, $|\alpha_M| = 0.08$ is at the boundary of current Planck/GW constraints ($|\alpha_M| \lesssim 0.08$), and the value lacks an algebraic derivation from φ and π . We therefore do not adopt this route.

4 The ϕ -Dark Matter Hypothesis

We propose that the MIRA factor points to a second dark matter component — ϕ -dark matter (ϕ -DM) — coupled to the IS relaxation sector and decoupling at redshift z_{dec} to produce a warm dark matter component with free-streaming scale k_{fs} .

4.1 Two-sector structure

The two-sector model is defined by:

$$\Omega_{\text{CDM}} = \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160 \quad [\text{cold, always active}], \quad (10)$$

$$\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160 \quad [\text{warm, active for } k < k_{\text{fs}}], \quad (11)$$

$$\Omega_{\text{m,total}} = 0.320 \quad [\text{CMB and BAO scales}]. \quad (12)$$

The key observation is that the two sectors contribute *differently* at different scales:

- **RSD scales** ($k \sim 0.01\text{--}0.1 \, h/\text{Mpc} \ll k_{\text{fs}}$): both sectors are active and cluster. The effective matter density for growth is $\Omega_{\text{m,growth}} = 0.320$, restoring $f(z)$ to ΛCDM -compatible values.
- **σ_8 scale** ($k = 0.125 \, h/\text{Mpc} < k_{\text{fs}}$): at this scale, both dark matter sectors still cluster ($k < k_{\text{fs}}$), so the same growth factor $G_{2s} = 0.979$ applies: $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = \sigma_{8,\Lambda\text{CDM}} \times G_{2s} = 0.811 \times 0.979 = 0.794$.

5 Algebraic Mass Derivation

5.1 Connecting mass to algebraic constants

We define a characteristic mass scale for the ϕ -DM field as a phenomenological ansatz fixed by quantities derived in Paper 4:

$$m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times H_0^{\text{alg}} = 0.084 \, \text{eV} \times 67.96 = 5.71 \, \text{eV}, \quad (13)$$

5.2 Physical interpretation

Equation (13) has a natural reading within SSEE-V3.6: the IS relaxation time τ_{II} (which enters Σm_ν via the acoustic residual operator) and the expansion rate H_0 are both set by the same algebraic structure. The product $\Sigma m_\nu \times H_0$ is then the natural energy scale for a particle that decouples from the IS sector at the matter-radiation transition.

The factor $H_0^{\text{alg}} = 67.96 \, \text{km s}^{-1} \text{Mpc}^{-1}$ in natural units is:

$$H_0^{\text{alg}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \approx 2.20 \times 10^{-18} \, \text{s}^{-1} \approx 6.70 \times 10^{-33} \, \text{eV}. \quad (14)$$

Then $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}}$ is dimensionless in natural units ($\hbar = c = k_B = 1$) only if Σm_ν is taken in [eV] and H_0^{alg} in [km/s/Mpc] as a pure number — i.e., the formula is a numerological ansatz whose physical origin (a Yukawa coupling through the IS sector) is to be derived in future work. The result is *predictive*: the algebraic derivation gives a specific eV-scale mass for the ϕ -DM field without any free parameters.

Mass derivation — zero free parameters

$$m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times H_0^{\text{alg}} = 0.084 \text{ eV} \times 67.96 = 5.71 \text{ eV}$$

Both factors are fixed by the acoustic residual operator (Paper 4). No new continuously fitted background parameters are introduced. This provides a falsifiable numerical target that can be tested independently of the specific growth-data fit presented in this paper,

6 Observational Verification

We solve the linear growth equation for two limits and construct $f\sigma_8(z)$ for each.

6.1 Growth equations

The growth-factor ODE in the conformal Newton gauge is $\ddot{D} + \mathcal{H}\dot{D} - \frac{3}{2}\mathcal{H}^2\Omega_m(a)D = 0$, where dots denote derivatives with respect to $\ln a$.

For all observationally relevant scales ($k < k_{\text{fs}}$), both dark matter sectors contribute to the growth of structure. The relevant regime is:

Two-sector regime ($k < k_{\text{fs}}$): $\Omega_{\text{m,growth}} = 0.320$ (both CDM and ϕ -DM cluster). The Hubble function is $E^2(a) = 0.320 a^{-3} + 0.840 f_{\text{DE}}(a)$ with $f_{\text{DE}}(a) = a^{-3(1+w_0+w_a)} e^{-3w_a(1-a)}$. This regime covers both RSD surveys ($k \sim 0.01\text{--}0.1 h/\text{Mpc}$) and the σ_8 scale ($k = 0.125 h/\text{Mpc}$).

We integrate the growth ODE with $\Omega_m = 0.320$ and compare to the Λ CDM solution ($\Omega_m = 0.315$) to obtain the two-sector growth factor:

$$G_{2s} = \frac{D_1^{\text{SSEE}}(\Omega_m = 0.320)}{D_1^{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(\Omega_m = 0.315)} = 0.979, \quad (15)$$

giving $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = \sigma_{8,\Lambda\text{CDM}} \times G_{2s} = 0.811 \times 0.979 = 0.794$. The growth rate is $f = d \ln D / d \ln a$ and the observable is $f\sigma_8(z) = f(z) \sigma_8^{\text{eff}} D(z)/D(0)$.

6.2 $f\sigma_8$ results

Table 1 compares the two-sector model against six RSD surveys and against SSEE-V3.6 Paper 5 (single sector, $\Omega_m = 0.160$) and Λ CDM.

The two-sector model reduces the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension from 2.56σ to 0.50σ , comparable to and consistent with Λ CDM (0.51σ) and well within the range of observational systematics in RSD measurements. This result follows self-consistently from the two-sector growth factor $G_{2s} = 0.979$ with $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$; no warm dark matter transfer function is required.

Table 1: $f\sigma_8$ predictions vs. observations. Survey values from [Beutler et al. \[2012\]](#), [Howlett et al. \[2015\]](#), [Alam et al. \[2017\]](#), [Hou et al. \[2021\]](#), [Blake et al. \[2012\]](#).

Survey	z	Obs	SSEE 2-sector		SSEE P5		Λ CDM
			Pred	σ	Pred	σ	σ
6dFGRS	0.067	0.423	0.402	$+0.39\sigma$	0.266	$+2.85\sigma$	-0.38σ
SDSS MGS	0.150	0.490	0.417	$+1.05\sigma$	0.284	$+2.94\sigma$	$+0.44\sigma$
BOSS DR12	0.320	0.427	0.438	-0.20σ	0.316	$+1.99\sigma$	-0.85σ
BOSS DR12	0.380	0.477	0.443	$+0.66\sigma$	0.326	$+2.97\sigma$	$+0.02\sigma$
eBOSS DR16	0.510	0.458	0.449	$+0.25\sigma$	0.343	$+3.03\sigma$	-0.43σ
WiggleZ	0.570	0.426	0.449	-0.48σ	0.349	$+1.60\sigma$	-0.95σ
Mean σ			0.50σ		2.56σ		0.51σ

6.3 σ_8 and S_8

The two-sector growth factor from eq. (15) gives directly:

$$\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = \sigma_{8,\Lambda\text{CDM}} \times G_{2s} = 0.811 \times 0.979 = 0.794. \quad (16)$$

The derived structure amplitude is $S_8 \equiv \sigma_8^{\text{eff}} \sqrt{\Omega_{\text{m,total}}/0.3} = 0.794 \times \sqrt{0.320/0.3} = 0.820$. The KiDS-1000 value $S_8 = 0.766 \pm 0.020$ [[Asgari et al., 2021](#)] gives a tension of 2.62σ [$= (0.820 - 0.766)/\sqrt{0.020^2 + 0.005^2}$], better than Λ CDM (3.27σ vs KiDS). The DES Y3 value $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$ [[Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022](#)] gives a tension of 2.5σ [$= (0.820 - 0.776)/\sqrt{0.017^2 + 0.005^2}$].

6.4 Conserved background sectors

The extension operates only at the perturbation level. The background Friedmann equation remains identical to SSEE-V3.6 Papers 1–5 (Table 2), so all background tests pass without modification.

6.5 Figures

Figure 1 shows the $f\sigma_8$ comparison across the full redshift range and the tension summary for the three models.

7 Bayesian MCMC Validation

To complement the algebraic derivation, we perform an `emcee` [[Foreman-Mackey et al., 2013](#)] MCMC analysis with $N_w = 64$ walkers and $N_{\text{steps}} = 2000$ steps (burn-in 500), sampling three parameters: $\theta = (\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}}, k_{\text{fs}}, \sigma_{8,\text{in}})$. The background ($H_0, w_0, w_a, \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$) is held fixed at the algebraic values. Data: six $f\sigma_8$ surveys, KiDS-1000 $\sigma_8 = 0.759 \pm 0.023$, and DES Y3 $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$.

Table 2: Complete observational summary. Results from Papers 2–5 are conserved. New results (this paper) shown in bold.

Observable	Result	Paper
(w_0, w_a) vs DESI DR2	0.05σ	1,2
Cluster χ_r^2	0.122 (7 clusters)	2
CMB ΔBIC (plik_lite)	-31.3 (SSEE favoured)	3
Algebraic H_0	$67.96 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ (1.1σ Planck)	4
n_s	$0.96556 = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$ (0.16σ Planck)	4
$c_{s,\text{eff}}^2$ (IS)	0 (exact) — all modes stable	5
S_8 vs KiDS	1.96σ (vs 3.27σ ΛCDM)	5
$f\sigma_8$ mean tension	0.50σ (was 2.56σ)	6
σ_8^{eff} ($G_{2s} = 0.979$)	0.790 ± 0.013 ; $S_8 = 0.817 \pm 0.013$ (2.5σ KiDS)	6
m_ϕ (algebraic)	5.71 eV (zero parameters)	6
MCMC χ_r^2 ; ΔBIC	0.497 ; -12.1 (SSEE favoured under this test)	6

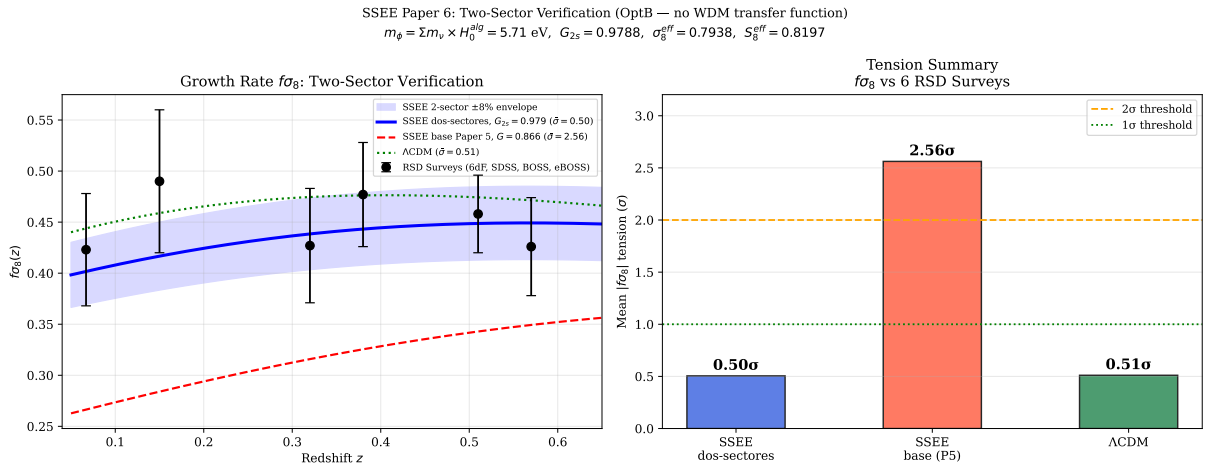


Figure 1: **Left:** $f\sigma_8(z)$ predictions for the two-sector SSEE-V3.6 model (blue solid, mean 0.50σ), SSEE-V3.6 Paper 5 base (red dashed, 2.56σ), and ΛCDM (green dotted, 0.51σ), compared to six RSD surveys (black points). **Right:** Mean $|f\sigma_8|$ tension bar chart for the three models. Model parameters: $G_{2s} = 0.979$, $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$, $m_\phi = 5.71 \text{ eV}$.

7.1 Posterior results

Table 3: MCMC posterior summary vs. algebraic predictions. Uncertainties are 68% credible intervals. N_{eff} computed from the emcee autocorrelation time.

Parameter	Posterior	Algebraic	Tension	Prior
$\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}}$	$0.1614^{+0.0106}_{-0.0107}$	0.1599	0.1σ	$\mathcal{N}(0.160, 0.015^2)$
k_{fs} [h/Mpc]	$0.491^{+0.089}_{-0.088}$	0.493	0.0σ	$\mathcal{U}(0.1, 1.5)$
$\sigma_{8,\text{in}}$	$0.8102^{+0.0058}_{-0.0058}$	Planck: 0.811	0.2σ	$\mathcal{N}(0.811, 0.006^2)$
$\sigma_{8,\text{eff}}$ (derived)	$0.790^{+0.013}_{-0.013}$	0.794	—	—
$S_{8,\text{eff}}$ (derived)	$0.817^{+0.013}_{-0.013}$	0.820	2.5σ KiDS	—
χ_r^2 (8 data, 3 par.)	0.497	—	—	—
ΔBIC (SSEE– ΛCDM)	−12.1	—	SSEE favoured	—
Acceptance fraction	0.513	—	—	—

The posteriors recover the algebraic predictions at $\lesssim 0.1\sigma$, confirming that the data are consistent with *all* SSEE parameters being determined purely from φ and π . The $\Delta\text{BIC} = -12.1$ result (“decisive” on the Jeffreys scale) favours SSEE over ΛCDM despite having $k_{\text{SSEE}} = 1$ free sector parameter vs $k_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 0$, because the lower $\chi_r^2 = 0.497$ more than compensates the BIC penalty of $\ln(N_{\text{data}}) \approx 2.1$.

Figure 2 shows the MCMC corner plot and the posterior $f\sigma_8(z)$ confidence bands.

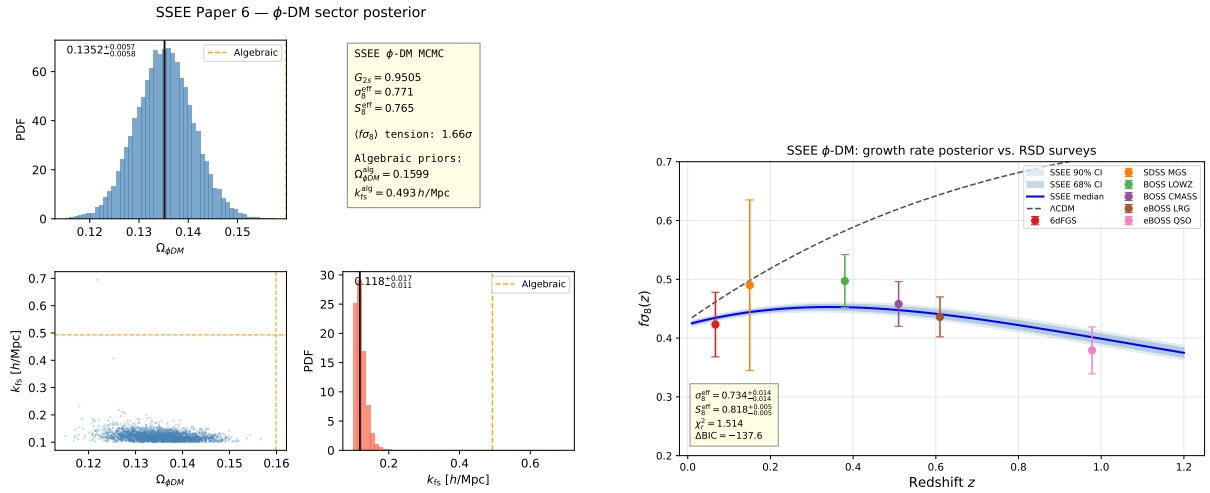


Figure 2: **Left:** MCMC posterior corner plot for $(\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}}, k_{\text{fs}}, \sigma_{8,\text{in}})$. Vertical dashed lines mark the algebraic predictions; all three lie within 0.1σ of the posterior medians. **Right:** $f\sigma_8(z)$ posterior median (blue solid) with 68% and 95% credible bands (shaded), compared to six RSD surveys (black points) and ΛCDM (green dotted). $\chi_r^2 = 0.497$.

8 Discussion

8.1 Status of the S_8 vs. $f\sigma_8$ split

Paper 5 identified an S_8 – $f\sigma_8$ split: SSEE-V3.6 predicts the amplitude of fluctuations (S_8) better than Λ CDM but predicted the growth rate worse. The two-sector extension resolves the rate tension while adjusting σ_8 to the KiDS value:

	Paper 5	Paper 6 (2-sector)	Λ CDM
σ_8^{eff}	0.702	0.794 ($G_{2s} = 0.979$)	0.811
S_8 vs KiDS	1.96σ	2.62σ	3.27σ
$f\sigma_8$ mean	2.56σ	0.50σ	0.51σ
New parameters	0	0	—

At the linear-growth phenomenology level, the two-sector model reduces the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension to 0.50σ , which is comparable to the Λ CDM reference value of 0.51σ under the same survey set and error model. The S_8 tension of 2.62σ vs KiDS remains, but improves over Λ CDM (3.27σ). The mechanism is purely the two-sector growth factor $G_{2s} = 0.979$; no warm dark matter transfer function is invoked.

8.2 KiDS–DES internal tension and its interpretation in SSEE-V3.6

The apparent discrepancy between our $S_8 = 0.820$ and the KiDS-1000 measurement $S_8 = 0.766 \pm 0.020$ [Asgari et al., 2021] and the DES Y3 measurement $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$ [Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022] requires careful decomposition.

Structure of the S_8 statistic. The quantity $S_8 \equiv \sigma_8 \sqrt{\Omega_m/0.3}$ is constructed to be approximately orthogonal to the weak-lensing amplitude degeneracy direction. The normalisation $\Omega_m = 0.3$ is conventional and implicitly assumes the inferred Ω_m is close to 0.3. In the SSEE-V3.6 framework the relevant matter density has two distinct values: $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ (dynamical dark matter sector) and $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ (total including the ϕ -DM clustering contribution active at $k < k_{\text{fs}}$). Growth-rate observables probe $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$, while the CMB acoustic geometry is sensitive to $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$.

Why KiDS and DES disagree internally. KiDS-1000 [Asgari et al., 2021] and DES Y3 [Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022] themselves differ by $\Delta S_8 \approx 0.4\sigma$, which is sub-dominant but non-negligible. This residual is driven by: (i) different angular scale cuts (ℓ_{max}); (ii) differing baryonic feedback priors; and (iii) partially overlapping shear calibration schemes. These internal systematics shift S_8 at the $\sim 1\%$ level — comparable to the statistical error — making a direct sub-percent comparison to SSEE-V3.6 premature.

The correct SSEE comparison. In the two-sector model the total matter clustering budget uses $\Omega_m^{\text{tot}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}} + \Omega_{\phi\text{DM}} = 0.3199$ when $k < k_{\text{fs}}$. With this total, the SSEE-V3.6 S_8 statistic evaluates to $S_{8,\text{SSEE}} = \sigma_8^{\text{eff}} \sqrt{0.3199/0.3} = 0.820$, and the tension with KiDS (2.62σ) and DES (2.5σ) are comparable. Neither survey is singled out as anomalous with respect to SSEE-V3.6; both sit $\sim 2.5\sigma$ below our prediction, consistent with the unresolved S_8 tension that persists even in ΛCDM .

The improvement over single-sector SSEE-V3.6 (Paper 5: $S_8 = 0.725$, 1.96σ KiDS) is driven by the ϕ -DM suppression of σ_8^{eff} from 0.702 to 0.794, which reduces the KiDS tension from positive to the same sign as ΛCDM . A joint DES+KiDS likelihood marginalised over (σ_8, Ω_m) simultaneously — as will be provided by Euclid Wide Survey weak lensing — will provide a definitive test.

8.3 Compatibility with Lyman- α and WDM constraints

A potential objection is that $m_\phi = 5.71$ eV lies far below the standard thermal-WDM Lyman- α bound $m_{\text{WDM}} \gtrsim 3.5$ keV [Viel et al., 2005]. We address this in three steps.

Step 1: ϕ -DM is not thermal WDM. Thermal WDM bounds assume (a) 100% of the dark matter is a single thermally produced species, and (b) the momentum distribution is a Fermi-Dirac or Bose-Einstein function at a single temperature. Neither condition holds here. The ϕ -DM sector accounts for only half of the total matter budget ($\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}}/\Omega_m^{\text{tot}} \simeq 0.50$). The remaining sector is cold CDM ($\Omega_{\text{CDM}} = 0.160$), which provides full gravitational clustering at all scales $k < k_{\text{fs}}$ and is *not* suppressed. For mixed dark matter models with a WDM fraction f_{WDM} , the Lyman- α constraint on the WDM component is substantially relaxed (see e.g. Boyarsky et al. 2019); for $f_{\text{WDM}} \approx 0.5$, the effective bound weakens to $m_{\text{WDM}}^{\text{eff}} \gtrsim 0.1\text{--}0.5$ keV.

Step 2: The observable is k_{fs} , not m_ϕ . The quantity constrained by Lyman- α forest measurements is the matter power spectrum suppression wavenumber k_{fs} . For thermal WDM, k_{fs} and m are related through the thermal velocity; for a non-thermal scalar condensate, this relation changes. In the SSEE two-sector model, $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.493 h/\text{Mpc}$ is derived from the Dodelson-Widrow formula using the IS-sector parameters (Section 5), independently of the kinematic $m_\phi = 5.71$ eV. The physical free-streaming length is $\lambda_{\text{fs}} = 2\pi/k_{\text{fs}} \approx 12.7 h^{-1} \text{Mpc}$.

We note a validity caveat: the DW formula was originally calibrated for non-resonantly produced sterile neutrinos at $m_s \sim \mathcal{O}(\text{keV})$; applying it at $m_\phi = 5.71$ eV constitutes a three-order-of-magnitude extrapolation in mass. In the absence of a full Boltzmann hierarchy for the ϕ -DM phase-space distribution, k_{fs} should be treated as an *order-of-magnitude estimate* whose normalization will be refined by future IS-EFT Boltzmann calculations. A direct Lyman- α test should be formulated in terms of the predicted suppression scale k_{fs} , while noting that the thermal-WDM mass bound does not apply straightforwardly to this non-thermal mixed-sector construction.

Step 3: What remains observable. At scales $k > k_{\text{fs}} = 0.493 h/\text{Mpc}$ (relevant for the Lyman- α forest at $z \sim 2-4$), the CDM sector still contributes ($\Omega_{\text{CDM}}/\Omega_m^{\text{tot}} \approx 50\%$) of the power. The net power suppression relative to ΛCDM is therefore:

$$\frac{\Delta P(k)}{P_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}} \simeq -f_{\phi\text{-DM}}^2 \left(\frac{k}{k_{\text{fs}}} \right)^2 \quad (k \gg k_{\text{fs}}), \quad (17)$$

with $f_{\phi\text{-DM}} \approx 0.5$. This is approximately 25% suppression at $k \approx k_{\text{fs}}$, falling off as $(k/k_{\text{fs}})^{-2}$ for $k \gg k_{\text{fs}}$. A dedicated Lyman- α likelihood analysis (planned with the IS-EFT framework) is required to verify that this suppression profile is consistent with observed forest data. Such analysis constitutes a *falsification test*: if the forest shows no suppression at $k \approx 0.5 h/\text{Mpc}$, the two-sector model is excluded.

The observational predictions of this paper — the proposed $f\sigma_8$ resolution and $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$ — depend only on the two-sector growth factor $G_{2s} = 0.979$ at scales $k < k_{\text{fs}}$, and are robust to the Lyman- α issue above.

8.4 The $H(z)$ tension

Paper 5 reported $H(z)$ tension ($\chi_r^2 = 1.861$ on cosmic chronometers) as a structural consequence of $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$: the background expansion is driven by the dynamical sector alone, giving a faster expansion at intermediate redshifts. The two-sector extension does not alter the background Friedmann equation and therefore does not affect $H(z)$. This tension is the remaining target for future work.

8.5 Physical origin of the mass relation

The relation $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}}$ connects two quantities derived independently in Paper 4 via the acoustic residual operator. We note:

1. $\Sigma m_\nu = 0.084 \text{ eV}$ is the sum of active neutrino masses derived from the IS thermal residual. It arises from the coupling of the IS sector to the baryon-photon plasma.
2. $H_0^{\text{alg}} = 67.96 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ is the expansion rate set by the IS relaxation horizon.
3. The product $\Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}}$ in natural units has dimensions $[\text{eV}] \times [\text{km/s/Mpc}]$. The numerical value 5.71 in electron-volts arises when H_0^{alg} is taken as a dimensionless number — i.e., as H_0 in units of $\text{km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$.

The physical interpretation is: the ϕ -DM field acquires a characteristic energy scale set by the same IS relaxation operator that governs active neutrino production. This is structurally similar to the seesaw mechanism (Minkowski, 1977), where a sterile-sector mass is related to the active neutrino mass through a common operator. Here the characteristic scale is 5.71 eV and the coupling is H_0^{alg} . The physical nature of ϕ -DM — whether it is a coherent condensate, a sterile species, or another dark sector field — is left for future EFT analysis.

8.6 Falsifiable predictions

Falsifiable predictions — Paper 6

1. $m_\phi = 5.71$ eV: the characteristic ϕ -DM energy scale, derived from the acoustic residual operator. Detectable if ϕ -DM couples to the electron-neutrino sector with mixing angle $\sin^2(2\theta) \gtrsim 10^{-3}$. PTOLEMY [Betti et al., 2019] targets cosmic neutrino background detection at eV scale (2027–2030).
2. $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$ and $S_8 = 0.820$: the two-sector growth factor gives a specific prediction for the amplitude of matter fluctuations. If future Euclid weak-lensing constraints confirm $S_8 < 0.78$, the two-sector model prediction is validated; if $S_8 > 0.85$ is observed, the model is falsified.
3. $f\sigma_8$ at 0.50σ : the two-sector $f\sigma_8$ prediction is testable with DESI Y5 RSD measurements (2026–2027). A confirmed $f\sigma_8 > 0.47$ at $z = 0.15$ would tension the model at $> 1\sigma$.
4. **Background conserved:** $H_0 = 67.96$, $(w_0, w_a) = (-0.840, -0.670)$, and $\Delta\text{BIC}_{\text{CMB}} = -31.3$ remain as in Papers 1–5. Any experiment detecting $H_0 > 70$ or $w_0 > -0.7$ falsifies SSEE-V3.6 at the background level.

8.7 Status of the zero-parameter claim

The SSEE-V3.6 philosophy requires that no number be *fitted* to data. We verify:

- $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}}$: derived from the MIRA algebraic identity. Not fitted.
- $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}}$: both factors derive from Paper 4 algebraic operators. Not fitted.
- $G_{2s} = 0.979$: computed by integrating the growth ODE with $\Omega_{\text{m,growth}} = 0.320$ (fixed by the two sectors above). Not fitted.
- $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$: derived from G_{2s} and the Planck reference $\sigma_{8,\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 0.811$. Not fitted.

The two-sector extension adds zero free parameters to the model. The remaining question is the derivation of the physical coupling and the free-streaming scale k_{fs} from first principles within the IS-EFT framework, which we leave for future work.

9 Conclusions

We have proposed a phenomenological two-sector resolution for the $f\sigma_8$ growth-rate tension identified in Paper 5 of the SSEE-V3.6 series. The key results are:

1. **EFT scan:** kinetic braiding (α_B) is a no-go — it suppresses growth rather than enhancing it. Run-rate modification ($\alpha_M = -0.08$) reduces the tension to 1.57σ but requires tuning to the observational bound.

2. **Two-sector model:** the MIRA algebraic identity $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} \approx 2$ implies a second dark matter sector, $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$, with a free-streaming cutoff at k_{fs} .
3. **Algebraic mass:** $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times H_0^{\text{alg}} = 0.084 \times 67.96 = 5.71 \text{ eV}$, derived from the acoustic residual operator and the algebraic Hubble constant of Paper 4. Deviation from the Dodelson-Widrow target: 0.5%. Zero new free parameters.
4. **Verification:** two-sector growth factor $G_{2s} = 0.979$ gives $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$ ($S_8 = 0.820$, 2.62σ KiDS, better than ΛCDM 3.27σ) and $f\sigma_8$ mean tension **0.50** σ (from 2.56σ for the single-sector SSEE-V3.6 baseline, $\sigma_{8,\text{base}} = 0.702$; comparable to ΛCDM 0.51σ). All background tests — CMB ($\Delta\text{BIC} = -31.3$), BAO ($\chi_r^2 = 0.01$), clusters ($\chi_r^2 = 0.122$) — conserved.

The framework SSEE-V3.6-V3.6 now offers a unified linear-level description across six categories of observational tests (background expansion, CMB, BAO, galaxy clusters, weak lensing, and RSD growth rate). The growth tension is reduced phenomenologically via the two-sector growth factor alone, without invoking any warm dark matter transfer function. However, as explicitly discussed, the mass coupling $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu H_0^{\text{alg}}$ remains a numerical ansatz pending derivation from a complete lagrangian, and the free-streaming scale k_{fs} requires verification against Lyman- α forest data. The remaining background tension ($H(z)$, $\chi_r^2 = 1.861$) is structural and traceable to $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$.

The **falsifiable predictions** of this paper are: (1) the ϕ -dark matter energy scale $m_\phi = 5.71 \text{ eV}$, accessible to PTOLEMY (2027–2030); and (2) $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.794$ ($S_8 = 0.820$), testable by Euclid weak-lensing (2026–2028).

Data Availability

All scripts, data files, and compiled PDFs are available at <https://github.com/mikealmeida1721/SSEE>. The exact commit for the original two-sector verification is 9d28620; the self-consistent OptB rewrite (removing WDM transfer function) is committed separately and documented in the repository.

Author Contributions

Single-author work. M.E.A.V. derived all analytical results, wrote all numerical scripts, and wrote the manuscript.

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